Applications for the Obama Leaders Program are currently open!

Apply to become a leader in one of our four global programs before the priority deadline on November 23, 2026.

Apply Now ↗

Leaders Program

The Obama Foundation Leaders Program is an eight-month, global virtual leadership development journey. Designed for changemakers aged 24 to 45 across various sectors, the program brings together diverse cohorts to collaborate, share insights, and strengthen their values-based leadership. The program is open across four regions and free to all participants.

How To Become A Leader

The Leaders Program is accepting applications from leaders ages 24 to 45 across Africa, the Asia-Pacific, Europe, and the United States. Submit your application by the priority deadline on November 23, 2026, to be considered for the 2027–2028 cohort.

Apply Today





What We Do/The Mission

We bring together cohorts of global leaders with various viewpoints and engage participants in exploring the challenges, opportunities, and skills needed to create positive change. We provide the tools and the community necessary to turn a shared commitment into a lifetime of impactful service.

How Leaders Works

The Obama Foundation Leaders program supports changemakers from the public, private, and civil society sectors to deepen their impact, explore values-based leadership, and drive lasting systems-level change. For 8–12 hours per month, the program connects cohorts of leaders across regions

Upon completion of the program, Leaders will become part of the Obama Foundation's Leadership Network: a growing community of civically active alumni developing tangible solutions to today's greatest challenges.

through virtual group sessions, collaborative peer-led spaces, and individualized coaching to build a values-driven foundation for sustained leadership.

Explore Values-Based Leadership →

Explore Leaders By Region



Africa

Leaders Africa is a six-month, virtual leadership development program that seeks to build a growing network of innovative and values-based changemakers who will drive positive change in their communities, the continent, and the world.

Learn More ▸



Asia-Pacific

Leaders Asia-Pacific is an eight-month hybrid leadership program that helps leaders develop their values-based leadership to advance inclusive and lasting change in their communities, in the Asia-Pacific region, and across the world.

Learn More ▸



Europe

Leaders Europe is an eight-month, virtual leadership development program that seeks to inspire, empower, and connect leaders to advance inclusive and lasting change in their communities, throughout Europe, and across the world.

Learn More ▸



United States

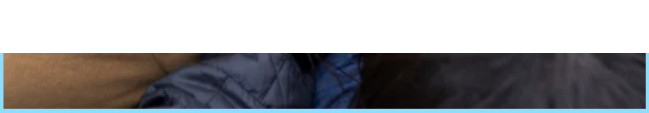
The Obama Foundation Leaders USA program is an eight-month, virtual leadership development program that seeks to inspire, empower, and connect leaders across the country.

Learn More ▸



Support Our Leaders Program

Your support is an investment in our collective future. By donating today, you help us keep the torch burning for leaders who will shape a more just world for generations to come.



Become a Member →

“I stopped leading from my expertise, and started leading from my humanity. The shift from advocacy to coaching, from telling to asking, from performing competence to practicing presence — that is the real transformation. I now walk into rooms with less certainty and more curiosity.”

– 2025–2026 Leader

The Impact Of Our Leaders Program

93%

of Leaders agree they are capable of navigating moments of productive intellectual tension.

96%

of Leaders agree they can clearly identify the core values that guide their leadership.

90%

of Leaders agree they feel confident about their role in the social change system they are a part of.

Stories of Our Leaders

More Stories From Our Leaders →



Han Pham

Pham is building connection, visibility, and civic engagement through her community-led work with Badass Asian Women.

Learn more →

William Smith-Stubbs

Smith-Stubbs tackles mental health, online hate, and societal division through bold campaigns and inclusive dialogue.

Learn more →

José Patiño

Patiño is doing the work to serve immigrants—from helping them afford college to ensuring they get due process

Learn more →

Could you be the next Leader?

Find out when applications open by signing up for Obama Foundation emails

First name

Last name

Email

Zip Code (optional)

Phone number (optional)

By providing a phone number, you confirm that you are an adult and consent to receive automated marketing and informational SMS messages from The Barack Obama Foundation at the phone number you provided. To learn more about how The Foundation would use your information, read the Foundation's Privacy Statement. Message and data rates may apply. Message frequency varies. You may opt out at any time by texting "STOP" to (773) 915-0096. Consent is not a condition of purchase or service.

☐ Yes, I agree to the Terms of Service

Sign up

Obama Leadership

Network

Get to know previous Obama program participants and graduates continuing to lead in their communities.

Meet the alumni →

DONATE TODAY

We need your help to turn hope into action—to inspire, empower, and connect people to change their world.

Donate

Mon/Wed: 12 - 8 p.m.
Tues/Thurs: 10 a.m. - 6 p.m.
Fri/Sat: 9 a.m. - 5 p.m.
Sun: 1 - 5 p.m.